

6. Opportunities and Constraints

This section presents information and discussion of issues that bear on the development of policies to conserve the cultural significance of the site.

The section begins with the implications of cultural significance itself, then follows the requirements of Uniting (NSW) and, finally, external statutory requirements.

6.1. Cultural Significance should be preserved

- The form, spaces and uses of the site that demonstrate its historical significance as an outstanding example of private philanthropy and its conversion by the Methodist Church to a war memorial hospital should be preserved and not obscured.
- The aspects of the site that are of aesthetic significance should be preserved. These are its intact spatial order, scale and planning of the estate, its four very good Victorian houses and stables, private streetscape, Victorian and 1920s landscape planting and features, 1930s hospital and chapel.
- The mansion tower and Norfolk Island Pines should be preserved as landmarks in the surrounding areas.

6.2. Opportunities for further revealing of significance

Where the significance of the site is obscured it should be revealed should the opportunity arise. Not all opportunities will necessarily be achievable or desirable. The major opportunities are as follows

- Removal of glass portico to reveal front entrance of 1935 Hospital
- Replacement of concrete driveways with more sympathetic material
- Reconstruction of grass bank to western side of Edina

Further opportunities exist in regard to details of the exterior and interior of the four Victorian houses, stables, summerhouse, and War Memorial Hospital and Chapel. These structures should be studied in more detail.

6.3. Opportunities for demonstrating significance

Opportunities exist to demonstrate or interpret the cultural significance of the site.

- Recreation of the original driveway path, in a manner similar to the original path (this would require the removal of buildings);
- Reconstruction of lower garden area (currently a carpark) to a garden area;
- Planting of trees which are missing from north west corner of the upper garden;
- Construction of a built form to close north end of service space behind Edina (where a Victorian outbuilding formerly stood);